

Paper: Reducing Prejudice and Support for Religious Nationalism Through Conversations on WhatsApp

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File: codebook.xlsx

This is a list of Variables that are in the three datasets used in the paper, with a brief Description and possible Values for each variable.

The Source column denotes which of the 13 surveys each variable draws its data from (see Appendix C.2 for more information on the surveys);

it equals "experiment" or "chat transcript" if the variable is constructed using information from the randomization procedure, the conversations, etc.

<u>Variable</u>	<u>Description</u>	<u>Values</u>	<u>Source</u>
<i>Variables in order of appearance in "Completes_Merged_Anonymized.RData"</i>			
s1.Responseld	ID of subject	-	s1
idthread	ID of conversation thread	-	experiment
condition_pair	randomly assigned pair type: Hindu-Hindu or Hindu-Muslim	HH, HM	experiment
condition_topic	randomly assigned conversation topic: non-political, general political, intergroup relations	non, gen, igr	experiment
condition_pt	condition_pair x condition_topic	HH_non, HH_gen, HH_igr, HM_non, HM, gen, HM_igr	experiment
religion	"What is your religion? If you are an atheist, please indicate the religion followed by the majority of your family."	Hindu, Muslim [all others excluded in recruitment survey]	s1
age	"How old are you?"	18 to 79	s1
gender_f	"What is your gender?"	female (1) or male (0)	s1
statelive	"Which state/UT in India do you live in?"	state or UT (27 possible values)	s1
state_zonal	zonal council based on statelive	Central, East, North, Northeast, South, West	s1
language	"What is your mother tongue?"	language (17 possible values)	s1
education	"What is your level of education?"	Class IX or below, Class X, Class XII, UG, PG	s1
college	college graduate based on education	college graduate (1) or not (0)	s1
castefw	caste classification	forward caste (1) or not (0)	s1
incomeamnt	monthly household income	0 to 10000000	s1
married	"What is your relationship status?"	married (1) or not (0)	s1
urbanity	"Do you live in a village, town, small city, big city, or megacity?"	village, town, small city, big city, mega city	s2
socialapps_WhatsApp	"Which of the following social media apps do you enjoy using frequently?" selected: WhatsApp	1 (selected WhatsApp) or 0 (did not select WhatsApp)	s1
socialmedia_score	based on responses to several questions on type and frequency of social media usage	9 to 45	s3
supportBJP	level of support for the BJP	extremely low (1) to extremely high (5)	s1

political_interest	"How interested are you in current affairs (political, economic, and social issues)?"	not interested, somewhat interested, very interested	s1
religiosity_score	average of responses to two religiosity questions	low religiosity (1) to high religiosity (5)	s2
PTscore	perspective taking score based on several questions	low PT (1) to high PT (28)	s2
ECscore	empathetic concern score based on several questions	low EC (1) to high EC (28)	s2
hasfriend_muslim	"Do you have any friends who are Muslim?" selected: yes	yes (1) or no (0)	s1
hasfriend_hindu	"Do you have any friends who are Hindu?" selected: yes	yes (1) or no (0)	s1
underwent.religious	sum of experiences with religious discrimination, religious violence, and communal riots	0 to 3	s3
feelth_muslim	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Muslims]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s1
feelth_hindu	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Hindus]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s1
feelth_christian	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Christians]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s1
feelth_brahmin	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Brahmins]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s1
feelth_dalit	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Dalits]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s1
feelth_bjpvoter	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [BJP voters]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s1
feelth_incvoter	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Congress voters]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s1
feelth_lgbtq	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [LGBTQ people]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s1
feelth_studentactiv	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Student activists]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s1
feelth_police	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Police officers]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s1
gr_patriot_hindu	"Generally, how patriotic do you think members of the following groups are?" [Hindus]	very unpatriotic (1) to very patriotic (5)	s1
gr_peace_hindu	"Generally, how peaceful do you think members of the following groups are?" [Hindus]	very violent (1) to very peaceful (5)	s1
gr_hardwork_hindu	"Generally, how hard-working do you think members of the following groups are?" [Hindus]	very lazy (1) to very hard-working (5)	s1
gr_honest_hindu	"Generally, how honest do you think members of the following groups are?" [Hindus]	very dishonest (1) to very honest (5)	s1
gr_patriot_muslim	"Generally, how patriotic do you think members of the following groups are?" [Muslims]	very unpatriotic (1) to very patriotic (5)	s1

gr_peace_muslim	"Generally, how peaceful do you think members of the following groups are?" [Muslims]	very violent (1) to very peaceful (5)	s1
gr_hardwork_muslim	"Generally, how hard-working do you think members of the following groups are?" [Muslims]	very lazy (1) to very hard-working (5)	s1
gr_honest_muslim	"Generally, how honest do you think members of the following groups are?" [Muslims]	very dishonest (1) to very honest (5)	s1
avg.ingr.outgr	average rating of ingroup on four attributes minus average rating of outgroup on those attributes	-4 to 4	s1
prejudice_binary	1 if avg.ingr.outgr > 0, 0 otherwise	classified as prejudiced (1) or not (0)	s1
cncn_misinfo	"How concerned are you about the following issues in India today?" [Misinformation]	not at all concerned (1) to extremely concerned (5)	s2
hndl_misinfo	"Do you approve or disapprove of the way the central government has been handling [misinformation]"?	disapprove strongly (1) to approve strongly (5)	s2
cncn_policecorr	"How concerned are you about the following issues in India today?" [Police corruption]	not at all concerned (1) to extremely concerned (5)	s2
hndl_policecorr	"Do you approve or disapprove of the way the central government has been handling [police corruption]"?	disapprove strongly (1) to approve strongly (5)	s2
cncn_indochi	"How concerned are you about the following issues in India today?" [India-China relations]	not at all concerned (1) to extremely concerned (5)	s2
hndl_indochi	"Do you approve or disapprove of the way the central government has been handling [India-China relations]"?	disapprove strongly (1) to approve strongly (5)	s2
cncn_indopak	"How concerned are you about the following issues in India today?" [India-Pakistan relations]	not at all concerned (1) to extremely concerned (5)	s2
hndl_indopak	"Do you approve or disapprove of the way the central government has been handling [India-Pakistan relations]"?	disapprove strongly (1) to approve strongly (5)	s2
cncn_econ	"How concerned are you about the following issues in India today?" [The economy]	not at all concerned (1) to extremely concerned (5)	s2
hndl_econ	"Do you approve or disapprove of the way the central government has been handling [the economy]"?	disapprove strongly (1) to approve strongly (5)	s2
cncn_democ	"How concerned are you about the following issues in India today?" [State of democracy]	not at all concerned (1) to extremely concerned (5)	s2
hndl_democ	"Do you approve or disapprove of the way the central government has been handling [the state of democracy]"?	disapprove strongly (1) to approve strongly (5)	s2
nchar_initial	length of response to an optional, open-ended question about social media usage	2 to 1189	s3
maybe_duplicate_friend	whether flagged as a potential duplicate or associate based on survey responses, messages, or profile	flagged (1) or not (0)	experiment

survey_weight	post-stratification survey weight based on age, gender, income, education, and urbanity (Hindus only)	0.03039 to 36.18109	experiment
Month	the month in which their conversation took place in the staggered rollout	February (2) to August (7)	experiment
s4.completed	completed the Day 1 Evening Survey (survey #4 overall)	completed (1) or not (NA)	s4
s5.completed	completed the Day 2 Evening Survey (survey #5 overall)	completed (1) or not (NA)	s5
s6.completed	completed the Day 3 Evening Survey (survey #6 overall)	completed (1) or not (NA)	s6
s7.completed	completed the Day 4 Evening Survey (survey #7 overall)	completed (1) or not (NA)	s7
s8.completed	completed the Day 5 Evening Survey (survey #8 overall)	completed (1) or not (NA)	s8
s9.completed	completed the survey sent out one day post-conversation (survey #9 overall)	completed (1) or not (NA)	s9
s10.completed	completed the survey sent out two days post-conversation (survey #10 overall)	completed (1) or not (NA)	s10
s11.completed	completed the survey sent out five days post-conversation (survey #11 overall)	completed (1) or not (NA)	s11
s12.completed	completed the survey sent out two weeks post-conversation (survey #12 overall)	completed (1) or not (NA)	s12
s13.completed	completed the survey sent out three weeks post-conversation (survey #13 overall)	completed (1) or not (NA)	s13
chat_wordcount_total	total number of words posted by the two subjects in the conversation thread	336 to 10470	chat transcript
chat_msgcount_total	total number of messages posted by the two subjects in the conversation thread	10 to 1175	chat transcript
pair_gap_supportBJP	absolute difference in BJP support levels between the subject and their conversation partner	0 to 4	experiment
pair_gap_education	absolute difference in education levels between the subject and their conversation partner	0 to 3	experiment
pair_gap_languageSame	whether the subject and their conversation partner have the same mother tongue	same (1) or different (0)	experiment
fq_religion_hm	whether the subject identified their conversation partner as a Hindu, Muslim, or other religion	Hindu, Muslim, Other, not answered (NA)	s6
fq_religion_correct	whether the subject identified their conversation partner's religion correctly	correct (1), incorrect (0), not answered (NA)	s6
fq_age_correct	whether the subject identified their conversation partner's age category correctly	correct (1), incorrect (0), not answered (NA)	s6
fq_language_correct	whether the subject identified their conversation partner's mother tongue correctly	correct (1), incorrect (0), not answered (NA)	s6
fq_state_correct	whether the subject identified their conversation partner's state correctly	correct (1), incorrect (0), not answered (NA)	s6

exper1_incident	reported experiencing: learning something new, arguing with partner, changing mind about something, feeling inspired by something partner said	string featuring learned, argued, changedmind, inspired	s6
exper2_overallmcq	"Overall, how would you rate the experience of participating in this study?"	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s8
exper2_partnerdiffic	"Did you have any difficulty understanding your partner?"	yes (1) or no (0)	s8
post.feelth_muslim	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Muslims]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s9
post.feelth_hindu	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Hindus]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s9
post.feelth_christian	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Christians]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s9
post.feelth_brahmin	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Brahmins]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s9
post.feelth_dalit	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Dalits]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s9
post.feelth_bjpvoter	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [BJP voters]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s9
post.feelth_incvoter	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Congress voters]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s9
post.feelth_lgbtq	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [LGBTQ people]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s9
post.feelth_studentactiv	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Student activists]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s9
post.feelth_police	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Police officers]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s9
follow.feelth_muslim	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Muslims]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s12
follow.feelth_hindu	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Hindus]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s12
follow.feelth_christian	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Christians]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s12
follow.feelth_brahmin	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Brahmins]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s12
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follow.feelth_bjpvoter	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [BJP voters]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s12
follow.feelth_incvoter	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Congress voters]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s12
follow.feelth_lgbtq	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [LGBTQ people]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s12
follow.feelth_studentactiv	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Student activists]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s12
follow.feelth_police	"Overall, what is your feeling about the following groups?" [Police officers]	very negative (1) to very positive (5)	s12
twit_HinduNation_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on India being a Hindu nation	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s8

twc_HinduNation_pos	social media reactions conditional on twc_HinduNation_q1==1	string featuring like, cmtpos, share, follow, ignorepos	s8
twc_HinduNation_neg	social media reactions conditional on twc_HinduNation_q1==0	string featuring angry, cmtneg, report, block, escalate, ignoreneg	s8
twc_HinduNation_action.sum	number of reactions selected in twc_HinduNation_pos or twc_HinduNation_neg; multiplied by -1 if twc_HinduNation_neg	-5 to 4	s8
twc_HinduNationFollow_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on India being a Hindu nation	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s13
twc_Hijab_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on hijab bans in schools	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s8
twc_Hijab_pos	social media reactions conditional on twc_Hijab_q1==1	string featuring like, cmtpos, share, follow, ignorepos	s8
twc_Hijab_neg	social media reactions conditional on twc_Hijab_q1==0	string featuring angry, cmtneg, report, block, escalate, ignoreneg	s8
twc_Hijab_action.sum	number of reactions selected in twc_Hijab_pos or twc_Hijab_neg; multiplied by -1 if twc_Hijab_neg	-5 to 4	s8
twc_HijabFollow_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on hijab bans in schools	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s13
twc_HinduWeap_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on using violence/weapons against Hindu nation opposers	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s13
twc_HinduWeap_pos	social media reactions conditional on twc_HinduWeap_q1==1	string featuring like, cmtpos, share, follow, ignorepos	s13
twc_HinduWeap_neg	social media reactions conditional on twc_HinduWeap_q1==0	string featuring angry, cmtneg, report, block, escalate, ignoreneg	s13
twc_HinduWeap_action.sum	number of reactions selected in twc_HinduWeap_pos or twc_HinduWeap_neg; multiplied by -1 if twc_HinduWeap_neg	-5 to 4	s13
twc_Terrorism_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on Islam and terrorism	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s13
twc_Terrorism_pos	social media reactions conditional on twc_Terrorism_q1==1	string featuring like, cmtpos, share, follow, ignorepos	s13
twc_Terrorism_neg	social media reactions conditional on twc_Terrorism_q1==0	string featuring angry, cmtneg, report, block, escalate, ignoreneg	s13
twc_Terrorism_action.sum	number of reactions selected in twc_Terrorism_pos or twc_Terrorism_neg; multiplied by -1 if twc_Terrorism_neg	-5 to 4	s13
twc_CovidDoc_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on the heroism of healthcare workers	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s8
twc_LangHindi_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on Hindi as the national language	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s8
twc_ChinaBoycott_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on boycotting Chinese products	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s8
twc_GBV_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on gender-based violence	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s8

twl_NatlmText_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on nationalizing school curricula and textbooks	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s8
twl_CovidUnity_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on unity during COVID	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s8
twl_Housing_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on religious segregation in housing	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s13
twl_Education_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on education infrastructure	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s13
twl_RusAgainst_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on condemning Russia	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s13
twl_Astrology_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on promoting astrology	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s13
twl_ChinaBoycottFollow_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on boycotting Chinese products	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s13
twl_RusSupport_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on supporting Russia	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s13
twl_LangAll_q1	approval of a social media post quoting a politician on language equality	approve (1) or disapprove (0)	s13
alloc_HH1	Decider Game: how many rupees allocated to first Hindu Receiver in first Hindu vs Hindu round	0 to 100	s10
alloc_HH2	Decider Game: how many rupees allocated to first Hindu Receiver in second Hindu vs Hindu round	0 to 100	s10
alloc_HM1	Decider Game: how many rupees allocated to Hindu Receiver in first Hindu vs Muslim round	0 to 100	s10
alloc_HM2	Decider Game: how many rupees allocated to Hindu Receiver in second Hindu vs Muslim round	0 to 100	s10
alloc_AnonH	Decider Game: how many rupees allocated to Anon Receiver in Anon vs Hindu round	0 to 100	s10
alloc_AnonM	Decider Game: how many rupees allocated to Anon Receiver in Anon vs Muslim round	0 to 100	s10
cgr1	selection in Chat Game Round ("CGR") 1: abstain, similar Hindu, or different Hindu	abstain, similar, different	s11
cgr2	selection in Chat Game Round 2: abstain, similar Hindu, or different Hindu	abstain, similar, different	s11
cgr3	selection in Chat Game Round 3: abstain, different Hindu, or similar Muslim	abstain, Hindu, Muslim	s11
cgr4	selection in Chat Game Round 4: abstain, different Hindu, or similar Muslim	abstain, Hindu, Muslim	s11
cgprefage	"Generally speaking, do you prefer to chat with someone who is of a similar age as you?"	yes (1) or no preference (0)	s11
cgprefregion	"Generally speaking, do you prefer to chat with someone who lives in the same state as you?"	yes (1) or no preference (0)	s11

cgprefgender	"Generally speaking, do you prefer to chat with someone who is the same gender as you?"	yes (1) or no preference (0)	s11
cgprefhob	"Generally speaking, do you prefer to chat with someone who has the same hobbies as you?"	yes (1) or no preference (0)	s11
cgpreflang	"Generally speaking, do you prefer to chat with someone who speaks the same language as you?"	yes (1) or no preference (0)	s11
cgprefreligion	"Generally speaking, do you prefer to chat with someone who belongs to the same religion as you?"	yes (1) or no preference (0)	s11
post.gr_patriot_hindu	"Generally, how patriotic do you think members of the following groups are?" [Hindus]	very unpatriotic (1) to very patriotic (5)	s9
post.gr_peace_hindu	"Generally, how peaceful do you think members of the following groups are?" [Hindus]	very violent (1) to very peaceful (5)	s9
post.gr_hardwork_hindu	"Generally, how hard-working do you think members of the following groups are?" [Hindus]	very lazy (1) to very hard-working (5)	s9
post.gr_honest_hindu	"Generally, how honest do you think members of the following groups are?" [Hindus]	very dishonest (1) to very honest (5)	s9
post.gr_patriot_muslim	"Generally, how patriotic do you think members of the following groups are?" [Muslims]	very unpatriotic (1) to very patriotic (5)	s9
post.gr_peace_muslim	"Generally, how peaceful do you think members of the following groups are?" [Muslims]	very violent (1) to very peaceful (5)	s9
post.gr_hardwork_muslim	"Generally, how hard-working do you think members of the following groups are?" [Muslims]	very lazy (1) to very hard-working (5)	s9
post.gr_honest_muslim	"Generally, how honest do you think members of the following groups are?" [Muslims]	very dishonest (1) to very honest (5)	s9
follow.gr_patriot_hindu	"Generally, how patriotic do you think members of the following groups are?" [Hindus]	very unpatriotic (1) to very patriotic (5)	s12
follow.gr_peace_hindu	"Generally, how peaceful do you think members of the following groups are?" [Hindus]	very violent (1) to very peaceful (5)	s12
follow.gr_hardwork_hindu	"Generally, how hard-working do you think members of the following groups are?" [Hindus]	very lazy (1) to very hard-working (5)	s12
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follow.gr_peace_muslim	"Generally, how peaceful do you think members of the following groups are?" [Muslims]	very violent (1) to very peaceful (5)	s12

follow.gr_hardwork_muslim	"Generally, how hard-working do you think members of the following groups are?" [Muslims]	very lazy (1) to very hard-working (5)	s12
follow.gr_honest_muslim	"Generally, how honest do you think members of the following groups are?" [Muslims]	very dishonest (1) to very honest (5)	s12
know_muslimvictims	true/false assessment of: "In India, Muslims are more likely to be victims of hate crimes because of their religion, compared to followers of other religions"	completely false (1) to completely true (4)	s7
discrim_muslim	"Overall, how much discrimination, or unfair treatment, do you think the following groups of people experience because of their identity in India today?" [Muslims]	no discrimination (1) to a lot of discrimination (4)	s12
happy_muslimbooked	happy/unhappy reaction to: "Walking home with friend, Muslim youth booked under 'love jihad' law"	very unhappy (1) to very happy (5)	s7
symp_muslim	"Overall, how much sympathy do you feel for the following groups of people who have faced discrimination or unfair treatment?" [Muslims]	no sympathy (1) to a lot of sympathy (4)	s12
comf_work_muslim	"How comfortable would you feel closely working or studying with a [Muslim]?"	very uncomfortable (1) to very comfortable (5)	s9
comf_relationship_muslim	"How comfortable would you feel if a close family member (e.g., your child or sibling) entered a relationship or marriage with a [Muslim]?"	very uncomfortable (1) to very comfortable (5)	s9
opn_reservation_religion	support for policy: "Reservations for religious minorities in education"	strongly oppose (1) to strongly support (5)	s9
opn_interfaith_bad	agreement with: "Interfaith marriages are bad for society."	strongly disagree (1) to strongly agree (5)	s9
opn_interfaith_ban	agreement with: "Interfaith marriages should be prohibited by law."	strongly disagree (1) to strongly agree (5)	s9
<i>Additional variable in "Recruits_Anonymized.RData"</i>			
cf2drop	whether the individual dropped out upon learning about the study's discussion component	1 if dropped out, 0 if signed up	s1
<i>Additional variables in "Starts_Anonymized.RData"</i>			
appearance_multiple	whether the individual was in more than one conversation thread (i.e., their first thread failed and they were then reassigned)	0 if they were ever only in one thread, 1 if they were in more than one thread	experiment
appearance_number	what number thread the current thread is for the individual	1, 2, 3 (by definition, always 1 for individuals with appearance_multiple==0)	experiment
completed	whether the thread was completed or failed	1 if completed, 0 if failed	experiment